MacroLens Daily Brief — July 21, 2026

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Top Headlines

1. **Oil prices rise to five-week high on US-Iran attacks, Houthi blockade threat - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-21 01:04
   Oil prices hit a five-week high following US-Iran attacks and a Houthi blockade threat against Saudi ports.

2. **Tankers with Saudi crude turn back as Houthis open new front in US-Iran war - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-21 18:05
   Tankers carrying Saudi crude turned back in the Red Sea after Houthis opened a new front in the US-Iran conflict.

3. **Two tankers carrying Saudi crude make U-turns in Red Sea after Houthi warning - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-21 14:20
   Two tankers carrying Saudi crude made U-turns in the Red Sea after a Houthi warning.

4. **Houthis warn shipping companies to avoid Saudi ports, email shows - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-21 16:56
   Houthis warned shipping companies to avoid Saudi ports, escalating supply disruption risks.

5. **Iran war 'stagflation' premium quietly mounts - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-21 13:04
   An Iran war 'stagflation' premium is quietly building, threatening higher inflation and slower growth.

6. **Houthi Red Sea blockade would lift oil prices, but workarounds could limit impact - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-20 22:51
   A Houthi Red Sea blockade would lift oil prices, but alternative routes could limit the overall impact.

7. **Tanker crew abandons vessel after reported projectile strike in Strait of Hormuz, UKMTO says - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-21 02:28

A tanker crew abandoned ship after a reported projectile strike in the Strait of Hormuz, heightening supply risk.

8. **Hormuz vessel crossings extend slide on fresh US-Iran attacks - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-21 02:13
   Vessel crossings in the Strait of Hormuz continued to decline amid fresh US-Iran attacks.

9. **As the U.S.-Iran war heats up again, these parts of the stock market and economy could be affected**
   CNBC — 2026-07-21 11:56
   The S&P 500 fell marginally despite escalating US-Iran conflict; Brent crude topped $90 and the 10-year Treasury yield rose above 4.6%, raising stagflation concerns.

10. **Stocks rebound as Mideast mediation pushes oil lower - Reuters**
    Reuters — 2026-07-21 02:02
    Stocks rebounded as Mideast mediation efforts pushed oil prices lower.

Market Snapshot

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
US Equities				
SPY	S&P 500 ETF	742.09	-0.16%	neutral
QQQ	Nasdaq 100 ETF	696.06	+0.10%	neutral
DIA	Dow Jones ETF	517.94	-0.55%	bearish
IWM	Russell 2000 ETF	292.31	-0.59%	bearish
XLK	Technology ETF	175.71	+0.07%	neutral
XLF	Financials ETF	56.04	-0.39%	neutral
US Treasuries				
SHY	2Y Treasury ETF	81.96	-0.04%	neutral
IEF	10Y Treasury ETF	93.54	-0.32%	neutral
TLT	20Y+ Treasury ETF	83.89	-0.75%	bearish
Credit				
LQD	Investment Grade Bond ETF	107.15	-0.38%	neutral
HYG	High Yield Bond ETF	79.68	+0.04%	neutral

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
Commodities				
GLD	Gold ETF	367.60	-0.22%	neutral
SLV	Silver ETF	50.98	+0.39%	neutral
USO	Oil ETF	125.51	+1.25%	bullish
UNG	Natural Gas ETF	10.29	-2.09%	bearish
FX				
UUP	US Dollar Index ETF	28.39	+0.21%	neutral
FXE	Euro ETF	105.37	-0.23%	neutral
FXY	Japanese Yen ETF	56.46	-0.09%	neutral
Crypto				
BTC-USD	Bitcoin	65230.03	+0.83%	bullish
ETH-USD	Ethereum	1903.76	+1.72%	bullish

Key Macro Indicators

Indicator	Value	As Of
Fed Funds Rate Target	3.5% – 3.75%	2026-07-21
10Y Breakeven Inflation (%)	2.26	2026-07-21
10Y-2Y Yield Spread (bp)	0.37	2026-07-21
VIX	18.65	2026-07-20
USD Index (Broad)	120.5315	2026-07-17

Major Anomalies

UNG — Natural Gas ETF `-2.09%`

Cause: Natural gas prices fell due to mild weather forecasts reducing heating demand and ample storage levels.

Forward Impact: Continued bearish sentiment is likely unless colder weather or supply disruptions emerge.

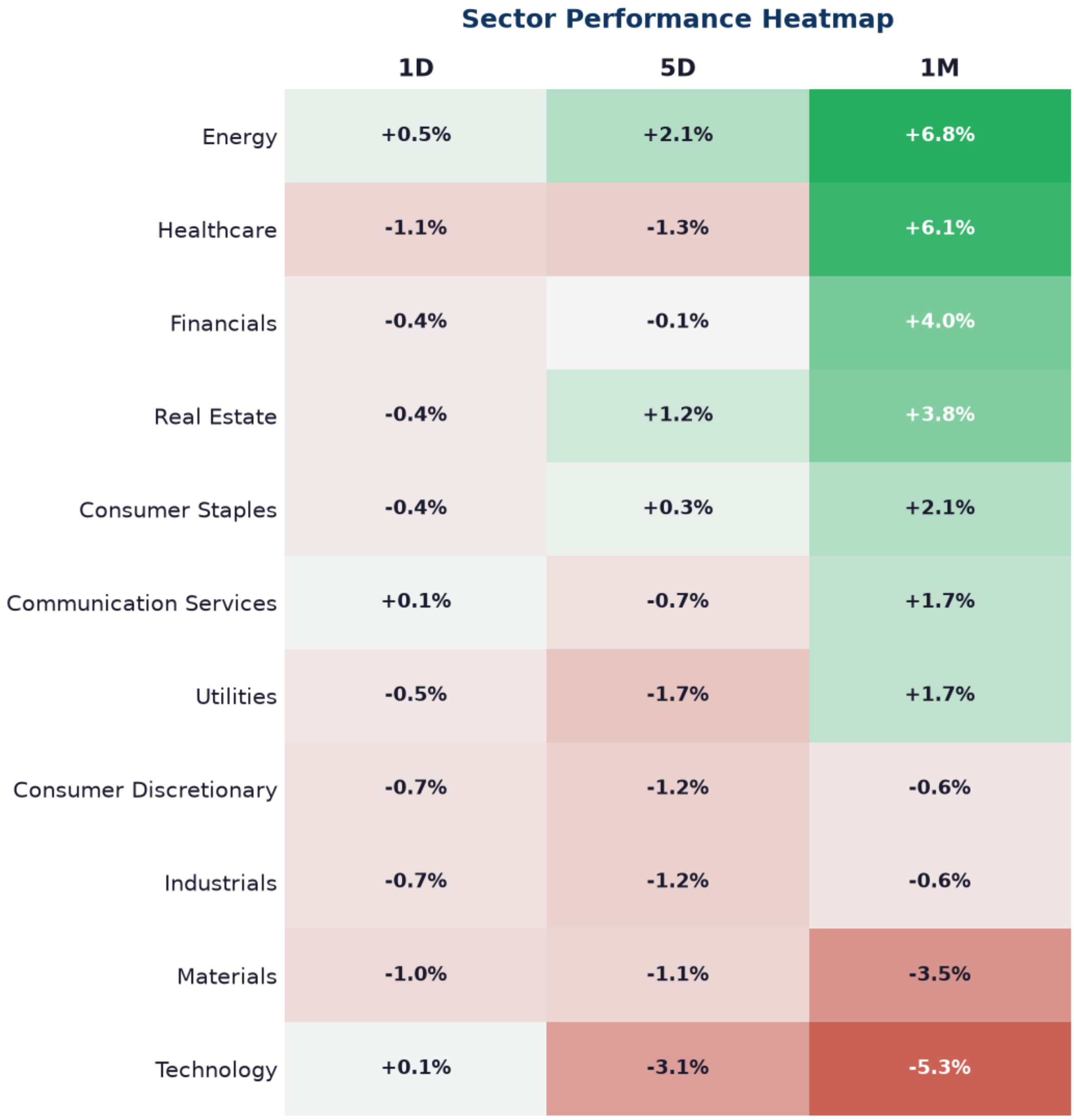
Macro Data Releases — Today

[Calendar error: 403 Client Error: Forbidden for url: https://finnhub.io/api/v1/calendar/economic?from=2026-07-21&to=2026-07-29&token=d88f5hpr01qq4342ton0d88f5hpr01qq4342tong]

Economic Calendar — Next 7 Days

No upcoming macro events in the next 7 days.

Sector Heat Map



Hot Now

- **Energy** — Strong positive momentum across 1d, 5d, and 1m timeframes
- **Healthcare** — Positive 1m return despite recent pullback, showing resilience
- **Financials** — Positive 1m return with stabilizing short-term performance

Cold but Worth Watching

- **Technology** — Sharp 5d and 1m declines, but long-term growth potential may attract dip buyers
- **Materials** — Negative momentum across all timeframes, but cyclical recovery could reverse

- **Consumer Discretionary** — Negative 1m return with recent weakness, but consumer spending may rebound

> Energy leads with strong momentum, while Technology and Materials lag but may offer mean-reversion opportunities as the market rotates from growth to value.

Daily Conclusion

> Energy and defensive sectors rally as geopolitical tensions in the Middle East drive oil prices higher, while risk-sensitive sectors like Technology and Consumer Discretionary weaken.

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